

COBRA

Bhujangasana

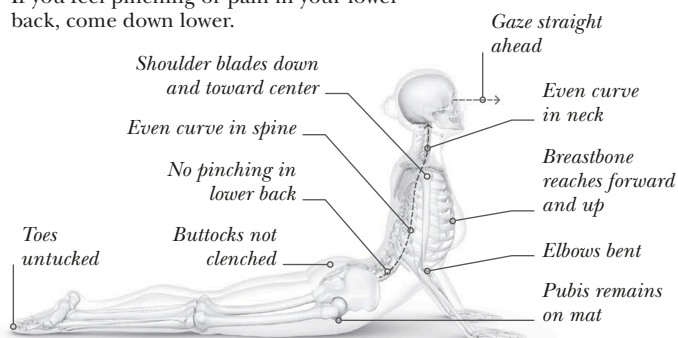
Cobra pose is a key traditional yoga pose. This gentle backbend was believed to ignite a burning digestive fire and awaken the flow of dormant energy. It does seem to stimulate digestion and elimination, while helping to ease back pain for many.

THE BIG PICTURE

The front of your body—including your chest, abdominals, and hips—is stretching. Meanwhile, muscles in your back, shoulders, and arms are strengthening as you maintain the posture, creating an even curve along your neck and spine.

ALIGNMENT

Your pubic bone remains on the mat as you elongate your spine into an even backbend. If you feel pinching or pain in your lower back, come down lower.



VARIATION

With your forearms on the floor, Sphinx can be a more accessible and more passive version of the pose.

Thighs

Your **gluteus maximus**, **adductor magnus**, and **hamstrings** engage to hold your hips in extension, while your **tensor fasciae latae** and **iliotibial band** stabilize your hips.

